

Sixteenth International Linguistics Olympiad

Prague (Czechia), 26–30 July 2018

Individual Contest Solutions

Problem 2. The sentences have the following structure:

$$\frac{S}{S \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} \text{-bə} & (S = \text{1st person sg, 2nd person sg}) \\ \text{kəmə} & (S = \text{3rd person sg, plural}) \end{array} \right. \overline{\quad} \quad \left. \begin{array}{c} \text{—} \\ \text{O} \end{array} \right\} V \text{ X ne,}$$

S: subject, O: object, V: predicate,

$$X: \begin{array}{|c|c|c|} \hline \text{1st} > \text{2nd} > \text{3rd} & \text{past} & \text{present} \\ \hline S \rightarrow (O) & \text{t—?} & \text{k-} \\ \hline O \leftarrow S & \text{t}^h\text{-} & \text{r-} \\ \hline \end{array} + \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{1st person sg} \in \{S, O\} : \text{-r} \\ \text{1st person pl} \in \{S, O\} : \text{-i} \\ \text{1st} \notin \{S, O\} : \\ \quad \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{2nd person sg} \in \{S, O\} : \text{-u} \\ \text{2nd person pl} \in \{S, O\} : \text{-an} \end{array} \right. \end{array} \right.$$

- (a)
1. **nɾ ʒip ku ne** — *Do you_{sg} sleep?*
 2. **ati kəmə nirum lapk^{hi} t^{hi} ne** — *Did he see us?*
 3. **tarum kəmə nuʔrum c^{ham} ran ne** — *Do they know you_{pl}?*
 4. **nirum kəmə tarum lan ki ne** — *Do we beat them?*
 5. **nirum kəmə nɾ c^{ham} tiʔ ne** — *Did we know you_{sg}?*
 6. **nirum ka tiʔ ne** — *Did we go?*
- (b)
7. *Did I beat you_{sg}?* — **ɳabə nɾ lan tɾʔ ne**
 8. *Did they see me?* — **tarum kəmə ɳa lapk^{hi} t^{hɾ} ne**
 9. *Does he know you_{sg}?* — **ati kəmə nɾ c^{ham} ru ne**
 10. *Do you_{pl} sleep?* — **nuʔrum ʒip kan ne**